

North Carolina Mental Health & Substance Use Services Workforce Data 2024 Snapshot:

PRESCRIBERS – PHYSICIANS, PHYSICIAN ASSISTANTS, & NURSE PRACTITIONERS SPECIALIZING IN MH/SU SERVICES

3,605
Total MH/SU
Prescribers
Active Practice

1,568
MH/SU Physicians

576
MH/SU PAs
Physician
Assistants

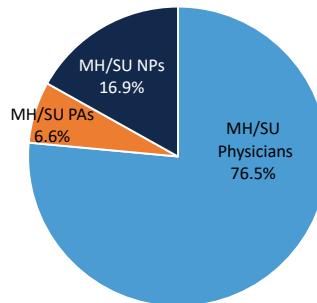
1,461
MH/SU NPs
Nurse Practitioners

The average rate for all MH/SU prescribers in-state was **3.28 per 10,000 population**. By type of prescriber, the average rate was:

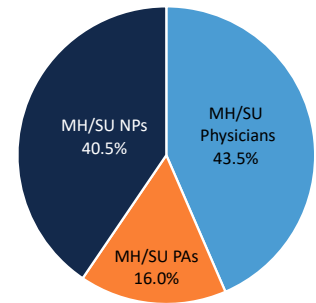
- MH/SU Physicians: 1.43 per 10,000
- MH/SU PAs: 0.52 per 10,000
- MH/SU NPs: 1.33 per 10,000

MH/SU = Mental Health and Substance Use Services

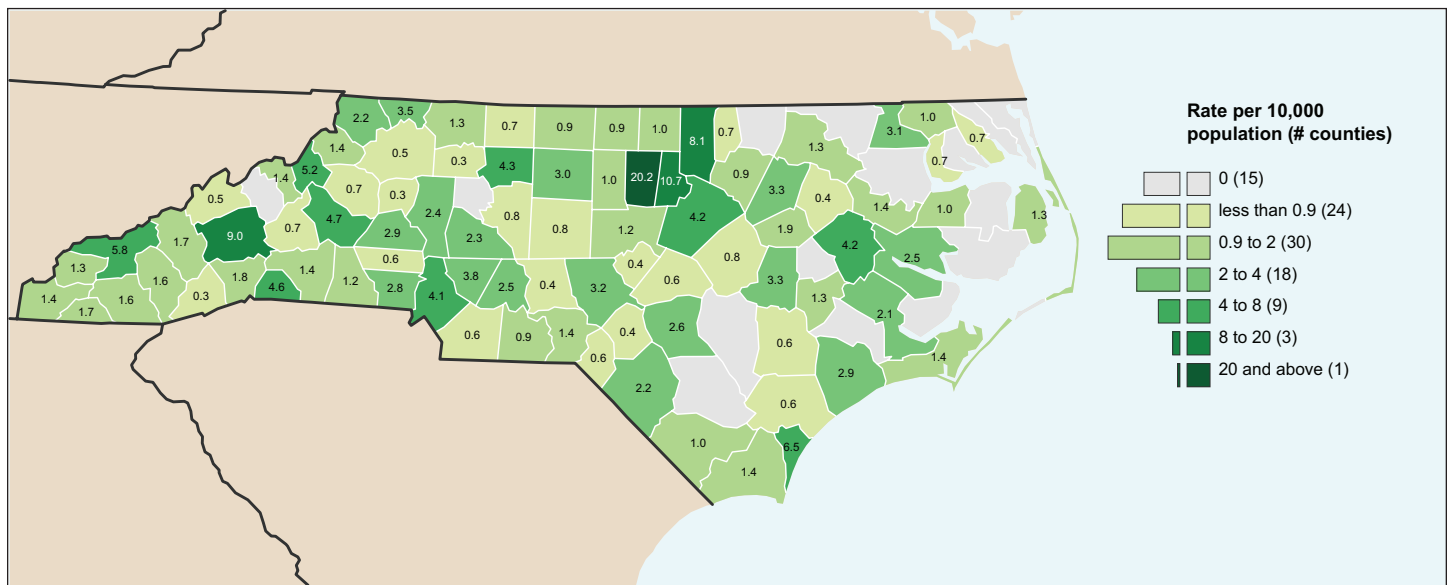
2014



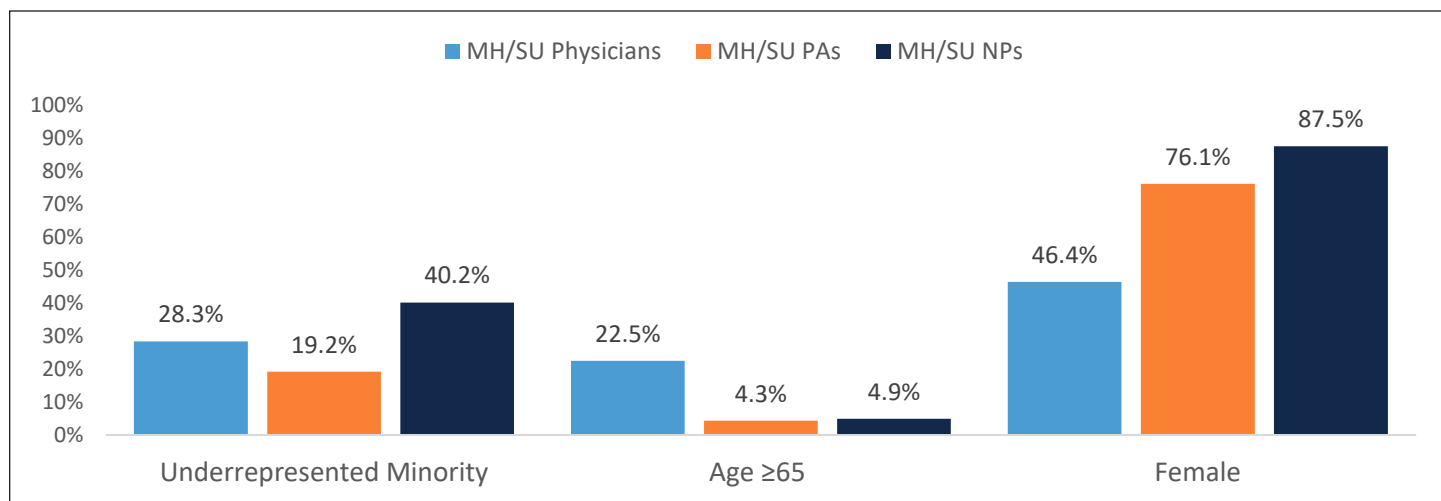
2024



MH/SU Prescribers per 10,000 Population by County, North Carolina, 2024



MH/SU Prescribers Workforce Demographics by Licensure Type, 2024

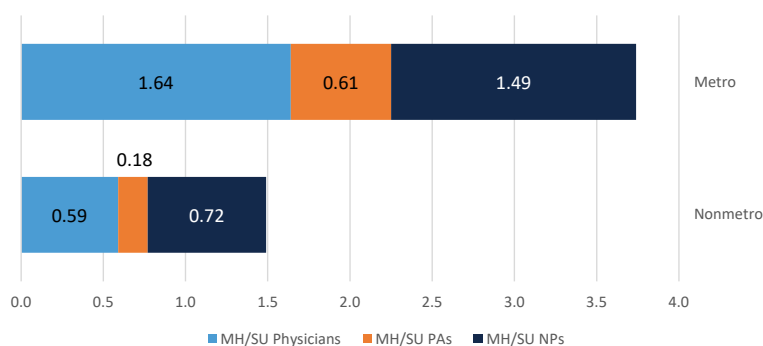


Demographics & Education, 2024

MH/SU prescribers:

- **67.8%** female
- **12.5%** ≥ 65 years
- **30.8%** underrepresented minority
- **30.7%** educated in-state (e.g., medical, PA, & NP), similar to 2014 education in-state (29.8%)

Metro and Nonmetro County Rate per 10k by Licensure Type, 2024



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Metro counties had 2.5 times the supply of MH/SU prescribers compared to nonmetro areas: **3.74 vs 1.49 per 10k**. Of the MH/SU prescriber types, **NPs had the highest nonmetro rate (0.72)**.
- The MH/SU Physicians workforce trended older than MH/SU PAs and NPs (22.5% ≥ 65 vs 4.9% and 4.3% respectively), while MH/SU NPs had the highest percentage of underrepresented minorities (40.2%).
- The rate of prescribers doubled from 2014 to 2024 (**1.65 to 3.28 per 10k**) driven by an increase in MH/SU NPs (**0.28 to 1.33 per 10k**).

For more information, please find the full report at: <https://nchealthworkforce.unc.edu/projects/mhsu-workforce/>



NC DEPARTMENT OF
**HEALTH AND
HUMAN SERVICES**
Division of Mental Health,
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Substance Use Services

**SHEPS HEALTH
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